

NEWS BULLETIN

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STATE OF NEVADA
104TH CONGRESS



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BRYAN PRESSES FOR AUDIT OF SUPER SECRET SPY AGENCY

WASHINGTON, D.C. -- Following reports that a super secret spy agency has accumulated \$1 billion in unspent taxpayer dollars without informing Congress, United States Senator Richard Bryan (D-Nevada) said today he will offer an amendment to require a full audit of the financial management of the National Reconnaissance Office (NRO). Bryan, a member of the Senate Intelligence Committee, said the amendment will also prohibit the NRO from accumulating surplus funds in the future and ensure an increased level of NRO budget scrutiny by the Office of Management and Budget (OMB).

"The most recent revelation concerning the NRO confirms the American public's skepticism about the intelligence community and its ability to live up to the public's trust," Bryan said. "This is an agency that is out of control and appears to have no intention of correcting its ways even in the face of continued criticism."

It was recently reported the NRO, a spy satellite agency jointly overseen by the Central Intelligence Agency (CIA) and the Department of Defense, accumulated \$1 billion in unspent appropriations. Bryan plans to offer his amendment to the Intelligence Authorization bill scheduled to be considered by the full Senate. Bryan informed the leaders of the Intelligence Committee Senators Arlen Specter (R-PA) and Bob Kerrey (D-NE) of his intentions earlier today.

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"No agency of the government should be allowed to accumulate taxpayer dollars without informing the Congress of their existence," Bryan said. "The NRO should not be able to hide behind the cloak of national security and conceal this money from Congressional scrutiny."

"It was a little over a year ago that reports revealed that construction of an NRO facility in suburban Virginia would cost between more than \$300 million and was a much larger facility than necessary," Bryan said. "Again, the costs were deliberately hidden from the public."

Bryan's amendment will:

- * Prohibit the NRO from accumulating surplus funds in the future.
- * Require a comprehensive NRO financial management review by the General Accounting Office.
- * Require that the NRO budget be subject to the full review of the Office of Management and Budget.

"In these times when so many Americans are being affected by federal budget reductions, it is inexcusable to have a federal agency whose spending seems completely out of control," Bryan said. "Opening the budgets of the intelligence agencies to greater scrutiny will help to restore confidence in the mission of the intelligence community."